

■ Raw

`Raw[h, "hexstring"]` constructs a raw data object with head *h*, and with contents corresponding to the binary bit pattern represented by the string *hexstring*, interpreted as a hexadecimal number.

`Raw` should be used only under very special circumstances. ■ It is possible to crash *Mathematica* by creating a fundamental *Mathematica* data object with `Raw`, and specifying illegal internal data for it. If you create an object with head `Real`, but with internal data incompatible with *Mathematica* `Real` numbers, you may end up crashing your whole *Mathematica* session.

■ `Raw` encodes data so that two hexadecimal digits represent one byte. Identical *hexstring* may lead to different internal data on different computer systems. ■ You can only expect to transport raw arrays of bytes from one type of computer to another without encountering byte swap incompatibilities. ■ See page 551. ■ See also: `Run`.